Cleaning Supply Starter List

Choose supplies for the surfaces and jobs you actually have.

01 Check the job before choosing a product

1. Name the surface and material, such as a laminate table or the toilet bowl.
2. Find its care instructions. If you cannot identify the material or suitable treatment, ask the owner or manufacturer before using a product.
3. Read the product label for suitable surfaces, preparation, use, waiting or rinsing, ventilation and storage.
4. Gather the required cloths or tools. A cleaning product is not automatically suitable for every surface, and a disinfectant is not needed for every ordinary cleaning job.

02 Match the supply to the job

JOB	WHAT TO CHECK FOR
Dishes	Dishwashing product and tools suitable for the dishes and your handwashing or dishwasher method.
Table, counter or appliance exterior	A product and cloth allowed by that surface's care instructions. "Multi-surface" still has exclusions.
Bathroom surfaces	A compatible product for the actual soil and material. Keep toilet tools separate from sink and kitchen tools.
Toilet bowl	A suitable bowl product and brush, used as labeled.
Glass or mirror	The care instructions may allow a damp cloth; check before buying a separate product.
Floors	Broom or vacuum and, if needed, a floor-care method approved for the floor. Not every floor accepts a wet mop.
Laundry	Detergent compatible with the washer and clothes. Follow its dose instructions and the item's care label.

03 Make a small shopping list

Inventory supplies first. For each missing item write the job, material, product requirements and maximum you want to spend. Compare labels and current prices; a store brand may suit the job but is not assumed identical.

- Buy a small size of an unfamiliar product.
- Check the trash-can size before buying bags.
- Choose a cloth or pad that will not damage the material.
- Buy tools only for jobs you have: a toilet brush, plunger, floor tool or gloves required by the label.
- Optional fragrances, gadgets and bulk packs can wait.

Keep products separate

Do not mix cleaning products. Follow their labels for safe use, ventilation and storage. Do not assume rinsing makes an unknown combination safe. Keep products in their labeled containers and away from children and pets.

04 Store so the next job is easy

Choose a safe, accessible storage place that follows each label. Keep toilet tools separate. Convenient storage helps only if it is safe for everyone in the household; duplicate bottles are optional.

If money or storage is tight

Choose the most necessary job first. Check which compatible supplies you already have, borrow an appropriate tool if possible, and buy only what is missing. Vinegar, baking soda and dish soap are not universal substitutes.

The finish: a checked list of what you have and what is missing for the chosen job, with a safe storage place. Buying supplies and doing the cleaning are separate outcomes.

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